

How bad for environment c.ai actually is?

Posted by u/_Kiriseek_ • 0 points • 5 comments

I'm not a big fan of gen ai, mostly because of ai "art" (I'm an artist myself and for me it's just sick to see someone generate ai photos, or videos. Let those things be made by humans, not machine) but anyway - I do not hate character ai. Because it's not art, it's a form of entertainment, often much safer than roleplaying with real people.

People always tell me that gen ai is bad for environment and other shit like that, but how actually bad it is? I've read a lot of articles, all of them say different things! People now blame gen ai (and character ai users) for making polar bears suffer or something. Does gen ai really pollute the planet that much? Does it emit so much greenhouse gases that the ice melts? Does it actually steal water or is it reusable (cuz I've seen a lot of theories, some articles/people say yes, some no)? I, honestly think it's more because of some giant companies like nestle. But I just want to know the numbers of how bad it actually is, I want to meet people who actually know a thing or two abt it.

I'll be also posting this on other subreddit where can I find people who are more anti-ai. I want to see just two sides of the coin.

Comments

u/lam-selfdoubt • 2 points • 2026-02-19 21:39 UTC

Generative AI in general is bad for a million reasons, beyond environmental. Health, safety, environment, creativity and IQ, etc.

like you said yourself, it's sick to see someone generate AI photos or videos, that obviously leads to art being STOLEN from REAL artists to "train" AI to replicate that art, which later will probably drive artist into unemployment once it's mastered.

Videos and photos, big safety issue. At the rate that AI is generating and perfecting movements, expressions, language and features, it's not going to be long before we can tell the difference between AI or reality. This is going to cause horrendous issues legally such as in court with false evidence to frame someone (and I wouldn't put it past our beloved leaders and companies to do so.) Also, people generative nudity pictures and videos OF REAL PEOPLE! Especially celebrities and horrendously, kid celebrities.

Health is also a thing as people are getting BAD addictions to AI (such as c.ai and ChatGPT) im talking

bad as in they're using AI as a form of THERAPY, feeling "loved" BY AN AI, shutting out friends, families, nature and activities to talk to a computer. AI also does not provide accurate answers and could potentially lead to someone offing themselves. Ive seen videos where chatgpt called a poisonous plant 'harmless' and I wouldn't be surprised. I use ChatGPT for educational purposes and the amount of wrong answers and mark schemes I get...if I used it to study full, I would fail.

And go environment, it contaminates the water it uses to cool down the data centers. That water is usually fresh/ clean drinking water that gets fills with chemicals which means neither humans NOR the data base centers can keep using it. So that water gets thrown out and the process repeats. We are currently on the track to run out of drinking water in 13 years!

u/-Brandonline- • 2 points • 2026-01-16 19:07 UTC

Every single thing that human beings do has an impact on the environment regardless of where it comes from, in fact you making this whole post is using electricity and water that contributes to environmental degradation, but either way it isn't going to change.

u/Greedy-Deal9373 • 3 points • 2026-01-15 17:42 UTC

I've never seen an actual proof but sure, let's suppose that AI is using water. The earth can't run out of water, it just goes back to nature, changes it's state, rains etc.

If water can be cleaned and reused i see no problem with using water sources for anything.

We can also talk about the ammount of trees used for pencils and paper, the components of a digital table, "waste of electricity".

We can see a problem on anything, and there are things worse than AI and water

u/lam-selfdoubt • 1 points • 2026-02-19 21:31 UTC

The water can not be cleaned and re-used, they use clean drinking water/fresh water to cool down AI data centers which contaminates the water with major chemicals, making the unsafe to drink or even try to re-use. So it's dozens of liters of waters per hour just getting contaminated!

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-16 04:42 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-15 15:37 UTC

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u/Anne_Onim_Ally_2408 • 7 points • 2026-01-15 13:16 UTC

Any convenience of modern life harms the environment. If you really care about water use or negative impact on the environment, you should also research the agricultural and livestock industries, thermoelectric plants, data centers and servers that support the entire internet, golf courses, and so on. Conveniently ignoring other factors that harm the environment is not caring about it, it is simply hating AI.